

Employee Handbook

Effective Date: January 1, 2026

Welcome to Northfield & Rowe Inc.

We're glad you're here. This handbook provides an overview of the policies, benefits, and expectations that guide our workplace. It is intended as a general resource and does not constitute a contract of employment.

Employment with Northfield & Rowe Inc. is at-will, meaning either you or the company may end the employment relationship at any time, with or without cause or notice, consistent with applicable law.

1. Employment Basics

1.1 Equal Employment Opportunity

Northfield & Rowe Inc. is committed to providing equal employment opportunity to all employees and applicants without regard to race, color, religion, sex, national origin, age, disability, genetic information, veteran status, sexual orientation, gender identity, or any other status protected by applicable law.

1.2 Employment Classifications

Employees are classified as full-time, part-time, or temporary, and as exempt or non-exempt under the Fair Labor Standards Act (or applicable local law). Your offer letter specifies your classification, which determines eligibility for overtime pay and certain benefits.

1.3 Introductory Period

New employees typically complete a 90-day introductory period during which performance and fit are evaluated. Benefits eligibility may begin on day one or after this period, as described in your benefits summary.

2. Workplace Policies

2.1 Work Hours and Attendance

Standard business hours are Monday through Friday, 9:00 a.m. to 5:00 p.m., with flexibility depending on role and manager approval. Employees are expected to notify their manager as early as possible in the event of an absence or late arrival.

2.2 Remote and Hybrid Work

Many roles are eligible for hybrid or remote work arrangements. Specific expectations, including required in-office days, are set by department leadership and documented in a remote work agreement where applicable.

2.3 Code of Conduct

All employees are expected to:

- Treat colleagues, clients, and partners with respect and professionalism.
- Comply with all applicable laws and company policies.
- Protect confidential company and client information.
- Avoid conflicts of interest and disclose them when they arise.
- Use company resources, including technology systems, responsibly.

2.4 Anti-Harassment and Non-Discrimination

Harassment or discrimination of any kind will not be tolerated. Employees who experience or witness such conduct should report it to their manager, Human Resources, or through the confidential ethics hotline. All reports will be investigated promptly, and retaliation against anyone who reports in good faith is strictly prohibited.

2.5 Health and Safety

Northfield & Rowe Inc. is committed to maintaining a safe workplace. Employees should report unsafe conditions, accidents, or injuries to their manager or Human Resources immediately.

2.6 Technology and Data Use

Company systems, email, and devices are provided for business purposes. Incidental personal use is generally permitted but should not interfere with work or violate company policy. Employees must follow data security practices, including using strong passwords and reporting suspected security incidents to IT immediately.

3. Compensation and Benefits

3.1 Pay and Payroll

Employees are paid on a bi-weekly basis via direct deposit. Pay stubs are available through the employee self-service portal. Questions about pay should be directed to Payroll within 30 days of the pay date in question.

3.2 Health and Welfare Benefits

Eligible employees may enroll in medical, dental, and vision insurance, along with company-sponsored life and disability insurance. A full summary of plan options, costs, and enrollment windows is provided separately during onboarding and open enrollment.

3.3 Retirement Savings

Employees may participate in the company's 401(k) plan after meeting eligibility requirements. Northfield & Rowe Inc. offers a matching contribution as described in the plan documents.

3.4 Paid Time Off

Full-time employees accrue paid time off (PTO) for vacation and personal use, along with separate sick leave in accordance with applicable state and local law. PTO accrual rates increase with tenure. Requests should be submitted in advance through the HR system and approved by your manager.

3.5 Holidays

The company observes the following paid holidays each year: New Year's Day, Memorial Day, Independence Day, Labor Day, Thanksgiving Day and the day after, and Christmas Day. Additional floating holidays may be offered depending on location.

3.6 Leaves of Absence

The company provides leave in accordance with applicable law, including family and medical leave, parental leave, military leave, and jury duty leave. Employees should contact Human Resources as soon as possible when a leave of absence is anticipated.

4. Performance and Development

4.1 Performance Reviews

Managers conduct formal performance reviews at least annually, with informal check-ins encouraged throughout the year. Reviews consider goal achievement, core competencies, and overall contribution to the team.

4.2 Training and Development

Employees are encouraged to pursue professional development. The company offers an annual learning stipend and internal training resources; details are available through Human Resources.

4.3 Progressive Discipline

Where performance or conduct issues arise, the company generally follows a progressive discipline process, which may include verbal warnings, written warnings, performance improvement plans, and, where necessary, termination. Northfield & Rowe Inc. reserves the right to skip steps or terminate employment immediately in cases of serious misconduct.

5. Separation from Employment

5.1 Resignation

Employees who choose to resign are asked to provide at least two weeks' written notice to allow for a smooth transition, though this is not required given the at-will nature of employment.

5.2 Final Pay and Benefits

Final paychecks will be issued in accordance with state law. Information regarding continuation of health coverage (such as COBRA, where applicable) will be provided upon separation.

5.3 Return of Company Property

Employees must return all company property, including laptops, access badges, and other equipment, on or before their last day of employment.

6. Additional Policies

6.1 Confidentiality and Intellectual Property

Employees may have access to confidential business information and are required to protect it both during and after employment, consistent with any confidentiality agreement signed at hire. Work product created within the scope of employment generally belongs to the company.

6.2 Anti-Retaliation

Northfield & Rowe Inc. strictly prohibits retaliation against any employee who reports a concern in good faith, participates in an investigation, or exercises a legal right.

6.3 Handbook Updates

This handbook may be updated periodically to reflect changes in law or company policy. Employees will be notified of material changes, and the most current version supersedes prior versions.

6.4 Questions

If you have questions about any policy in this handbook, please contact Human Resources at hr@northfieldrowe.example or speak with your manager.